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Gold slips below Dh500 in UAE as oil prices surge

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Gold prices continued to decline yesterday as surging crude oil prices revived inflation concerns and raised uncertainty over the US Federal Reserve's next interest rate decision.

Spot gold hovered around $4,140 an ounce after falling nearly a per cent in the previous session.

Meanwhile, US West Texas Intermediate crude surged 5.7 per cent to $109.60 a barrel, while Brent climbed 2 per cent to $111.69 as the Middle East conflict heightened concerns over tightening global supplies.

Oil prices remained near five-month highs amid attacks on Gulf shipping and renewed tensions involving Iran, which warned it had "no choice" but to assert authority over the Strait of Hormuz.

Higher energy costs could fuel inflation, complicating the Federal Reserve's interest rate outlook and weighing on gold.

In the UAE, gold prices eased by Dh2 to Dh3 overnight, offering some relief to jewellery shoppers.

Dubai's 24-karat gold fell below Dh500 to Dh497 per gram, while 22-karat traded at Dh460. Prices for 18-karat and 14-karat stood at Dh378 and Dh295, respectively. The decline offers UAE shoppers celebrating Dussehra an opportunity to buy gold at prices below recent levels.

SEE ALSO P-I

UAE, FRANCE STRENGTHEN DEFENCE TIES WITH FRAMEWORK EXCHANGE

TWO SIDES ALSO SIGN INVESTMENT DEALS ACROSS ENERGY, AI SECTORS

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and French President Emmanuel Macron yesterday witnessed the exchange of the Strategic Defence Partnership Framework between the UAE and France.

The framework was exchanged by Mohamed Bin Mubarak Al Mazrouei, Minister of State for Defence Affairs, and on the French side by Catherine Vautrin, Minister of the Armed Forces and Veterans Affairs.

Sheikh Mohamed and Macron also witnessed the exchange of an agreement on implementing arrangements regarding the defence industry.

This was exchanged by Dr Nasser Humaid Al Nuaimi, Secretary General of Tawazun Council for Defence Enablement, and on the French side by Patrick Pailloux, Delegate-General for Armaments.



UAE Presidential Court

■ Witnessed by Sheikh Mohamed and Emmanuel Macron, the framework was exchanged by Mohamed Bin Mubarak Al Mazrouei, Minister of State for Defence Affairs, and Catherine Vautrin, French Minister of the Armed Forces and Veterans Affairs.

Leaders visit Tawazun Industrial Park

Sheikh Mohamed and Macron yesterday visited Tawazun Industrial Park in Abu Dhabi as part of the French President's official visit to the UAE.

The tour included EDGE Group's entities ADASI, EPI, HALCON and POWERTECH. During the tour, Sheikh Mohamed and the French President viewed products from a number of advanced manufacturing facilities within the park and were briefed on the infrastructure and integrated industrial ecosystem it provides to support the defence, aerospace, and other strategic industries.

They were also briefed on Tawazun Industrial Park's cooperation with local, regional, and international companies and its role in enabling them to develop and expand their operations.

UAE-France Business Dialogue

Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, and President Macron attended the UAE-France Business Dialogue at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi.

The event formed part of joint efforts to strengthen the UAE-France economic and investment partnership and explore new opportunities for cooperation in priority strategic sectors, particularly energy, artificial intelligence and advanced technology.

Sheikh Khaled affirmed that the strategic partnership between the two countries has evolved to keep pace with global developments.

Sheikh Khaled and Macron also witnessed the signing of Memoranda of Understanding and contracts between Emirati and French institutions and companies, covering energy, artificial intelligence (AI) and advanced technology.

These agreements demonstrate both countries' commitment to broadening economic and investment cooperation, strengthening integration between their industrial, technological and research capabilities.

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NATION

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IN FOCUS

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ABU DHABI

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